

Strong 2-♣ Opening

Open 2♣ on any hand containing 22 or more points.

OR, open 2♣ with a hand containing 19-21 points and with 9+ playing tricks.

There are several methods of responding. For these Deals use the 2♦ Negative for all hands with 7 or fewer points. Any other response shows 8 or more points.

The 2♣ bid is artificial; Opener's second bid describes her hand.

2NT shows a balanced 22-24 point hand

3NT shows a balanced 25-27 point hand

2 of a suit shows a 5-card or longer suit

With a very weak hand (0-3 points) Responder should bid the "second negative" at his second turn. This is usually 3♣, but if Opener bids 3♣ then it is 3♦. If Opener should bid 3♦ at his second turn the second negative bid is 3♥.

Later bidding depends on the partnership, but unless particular conventions are in use then later bidding is natural.

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: West

Deal 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ -
♥ 6 4
♦ J T 5 4 3
♣ A J T 7 4 2

7
6 5
22

♠ A J T 7 2
♥ 9 8 7
♦ 8 2
♣ Q 5 3



♠ K Q 8 6
♥ A K J 2
♦ A K Q
♣ 8 6

♠ 9 5 4 3
♥ Q T 5 3
♦ 9 7 6
♣ K 9

West	North	East	South
Pass	2♠	Pass	2♣
Pass	4♠		3♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			

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SOUTH has a minimum 2♣ opening.

NORTH, with 8 points and a 5-card suit, should make a positive response, 2♠.

SOUTH shows the ♠ support first, to set the trump suit, and to give NORTH an opportunity

for a move toward slam if he wants to do so.

NORTH would now make a Control-showing bid IF HE HAD A CONTROL. Since he doesn't he just returns

to 4♠ which SOUTH passes.

Deal 2

West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A Q 9
♥ A K 2
♦ A 8 3
♣ A J 7 4

4
22 8
6

♠ J T 8 4
♥ 9 7 4 3
♦ 5 2
♣ K T 8



♠ 7 5 2
♥ J T 6
♦ Q J T 9
♣ Q 6 2

♠ K 6 3
♥ Q 8 5
♦ K 7 6 4
♣ 9 5 3

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			

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WEST, with 22 points and balanced, opens 2♣, expecting to rebid 2NT.

But EAST responds a positive 2NT, showing a balanced hand with 8 or more points.

WEST bids what his hand is worth, 3NT and EAST passes.

Deal 3

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 6 5 4
♥ K 6 4
♦ Q T 9 8
♣ J T 6

5
6 6
23

♠ Q J 7 2
♥ Q T 7 5
♦ 7 2
♣ 8 5 4



♠ A K 9
♥ A J 8 2
♦ A 6
♣ A K 9 3

♠ T 8 3
♥ 9 3
♦ K J 5 4 3
♣ Q 7 2

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South

suit and NORTH bids 4



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SOUTH opens 2♣ and NORTH responds 2



showing fewer than 8 points.

SOUTH bids 2NT with a 23 point balanced hand.

NORTH has enough points to bid 3NT, but with two 4-card Major suits bids 3♣ Stayman instead. SOUTH

won't confuse this as the second negative since that bid isn't used after a 2NT rebid.

So SOUTH shows her 4-card



Deal 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 6 3
 ♥ Q 8 5
 ♦ K 7 6 4
 ♣ K J 3

3
 11 24
 2

♠ J T 8 2
 ♥ T 3
 ♦ Q 5 2
 ♣ T 8 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7 5 4
 ♥ J 9 7 6 4
 ♦ J T 9
 ♣ 9 2

♠ A K 9
 ♥ A K 2
 ♦ A 8 3
 ♣ A Q 7 4

West	North	East	South
		2♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			
6NT by West			

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WEST has a balanced hand with 11 points, so she responds 2NT to EAST's 2♣ opening bid.

EAST bids 3NT. This shows 22-24 points, a hand he was planning to rebid 2NT.

WEST knows the side has at least 33 points, but no more than 35 so she bids 6NT.